

Purpose

This guide defines how Northstar detects, contains, communicates, and closes security incidents. It applies to suspected data exposure, compromised accounts, malware, and unauthorized system access.

First Response

Any employee who detects a suspected incident must open a Security incident ticket and notify the on-call Security Operations analyst immediately. Do not delete evidence, restart affected systems, or contact external parties without authorization.

Severity and Escalation

The on-call analyst assigns severity within thirty minutes. A Severity 1 incident affects customer data, production availability, or a regulated system. For Severity 1 incidents, the Incident Commander informs the Chief Information Security Officer and Legal within one hour.

Containment and Recovery

Security Operations isolates affected accounts or hosts. Engineering verifies recovery through monitoring for at least twenty-four hours. The incident may be closed only after the Incident Commander approves the recovery evidence.

Post-Incident Review

Within five business days, the Incident Commander schedules a blameless review. The review records timeline, root cause, customer impact, corrective actions, owners, and due dates.

For an active security emergency, contact Security Operations through the on-call channel.